

Michaela Bunakova, MSc., PhD(c)

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EDUCATION

PhD Sociology, McGill University, CA

Sept 2021- Apr 2027

Cumulative Program McGill GPA: 4.0/4.0

- I am a PhD5 Candidate and a Wolfe Chair 2025/2026 Fellow with a quantitative analysis stream and specialization in demographic methods and medical sociology
- My research is supervised by Professor Amelie Quesnel-Vallee and funded by the 6-year competitive FRQSC Doctoral Research Grant
- My expertise and research interest lies at the intersection of social epidemiology and policy, with a focus on how educational and literacy spillovers from family social network structures affect health inequalities in Canada

MSc Epidemiology, McGill University, CA

Sept 2019- Oct 2021

Cumulative Program McGill GPA: 3.8/4.0

- Courses in epidemiological principles and research methods with a strong quantitative and methodological focus, knowledge synthesis and statistical data analysis using R
- Focus on evaluation of health systems, social epidemiology, health inequalities and family health policy
- Thesis titled 'The effects of public policy interventions on social inequalities in drug use and drug-use related health outcomes: an umbrella review of evidence' focusing on the effect of policies on social inequities in drug use-related health outcomes using umbrella review methodology and primary data from Statistics Canada (supervised by Dr Amélie Quesnel-Vallée). The completed thesis contributed to an FRQSC Action Concertée on policies and social inequalities led by Dr Quesnel-Vallée.

MSc Comparative Social Policy, University of Oxford, UK

Sept 2018-Aug 2019

Awarded Academic Merit and Distinction for the MSc Thesis

- Courses in health policy and health inequalities, social policy analysis, comparative social policy, economics of welfare state with a strong focus on comparative research design, methodology, literature review skills, advanced social statistics, qualitative and quantitative research methodology using STATA software
- Focus on political epidemiology and the intersection between health disparities and social policy design
- Thesis titled: '*Marry a doctor, live healthier*' - A quantitative study of family health influence in Europe under different macro policy contexts explored the effect of welfare regimes on health concordance and health inequities in families using statistical regression with data from European Social Survey (supervised by Dr. Alexi Gugushvili)

BA (Hons) Politics, Philosophy, Economics, University of Manchester, UK

Sept 2015-June 2018

First Class Honors Degree, GPA: 4.0/4.0

- Courses in political theory, philosophical methods, logic, ethics, theoretical and applied economics, further statistics and data-analysis using SPSS software
- Focus on health economics, health ethics, medical sociology, social justice and demography of aging societies
- Health Economics thesis titled '*An Enquiry into the spillover effect of having a health professional in a household on health and health-related behaviour of family members: Evidence from the United Kingdom*' using data from Understanding Societies to identify health concordance patterns in families and external effects of medical knowledge
- Study Abroad Program (Jan-May 2017) at McGill University

International Baccalaureate, Impington International College Cambridge, UK

Sept 2013-July 2015

IB points 43/45

- School Valedictorian 2015
- The highest score achieved at Impington Village College and top 2% in the world

WORK EXPERIENCE

Course Instructor/Lecturer, Department of Sociology, McGill University, CA **Sept 2022- Jan 2024**

- During Fall 2022 and 2023, I worked as a course lecturer for SOCI335: Sociology of Aging and Life Course. I was responsible for designing and delivering a semester-long course to a class of 90 undergraduate students.
- Based on student course evaluations, 90% of students considered the course 'excellent' and 100% of students rated my instructorship as 'excellent'

Research Associate, Social Statistics Research Lab, McGill University, CA **June 2022- Ongoing**

- In Summer 2022, I joined Dr. Vang's research team to contribute to a CIHR project on the effects of premigration macro-level factors on perinatal health outcomes
- My responsibilities include conducting literature reviews, website development and working in the CIQSS data centre on statistical analyses related to immigrant maternal health outcomes

Teaching Assistant, McGill University, CA **Jan 2022- May 2023**

- I worked as a Teaching Assistant for SOCI304 (Sociology of Welfare State), SOCI366 (Neighborhoods and Inequality) and SOCI309 (Health and Illness)

Training Program Facilitator, CAnD3, CA **June 2020- Ongoing**

- I joined the Consortium on Analytics for Data-Driven Decision-Making (CAnD3) as a member of the module development and training support team for the 2020-2021 Trainee Cohort. My responsibility was to design a new Gender-Based-Analysis Plus (GBA+) module (now IDEA Module) for the purposes of CanD3 training.
- My additional responsibilities include administrative and operational roles, such as active communication with CAnD3 speakers, partners and funding agencies, troubleshooting, facilitating webinar sessions and other research tasks

Private Academic Tutor, VIPTutors, UK [Freelance] **Sept 2018- Sept 2022**

- I offer high-quality, private tutoring service and consultation to undergraduate students. My services include, but are not limited to essay writing advice, personal statement improvements, brainstorming and proofreading

Research Assistant, IRIS Laboratory, McGill, CA **Nov 2019- Nov 2020**

- Under the guidance of Dr Amelie Quesnel-Vallée and Dr Jaunathan Bilodeau, I assisted in systematic reviews from the International Research Infrastructure on Social Inequalities in Health (IRIS) as a second reviewer and data-extractor.
- My contribution pertained to two research studies; the first project examining the application of administrative data linkages in international research on income inequalities and disability among older adults; and the second project being a major component of an existing FRQSC Action Concertée, examining the effect of policy interventions on social inequalities in high-income countries.

Research Assistant, MOHSSR, McGill, CA **Mar 2020- June 2020**

- As part of the McGill and North American Observatory on Health and Social Services Reform (MOHSSR/NAO) team, I was responsible for writing and updating the Quebec COVID-19 Policy Monitor reform, aiming to capture all major policies in Quebec enacted in response to the global pandemic.

Fellow, Internship Award, IHSP, McGill, CA **Sept 2019- Dec 2019**

- As a recipient of the IHSP Fall 2019 Internship Award, I joined the Institute for Health and Social Policy for a semester-long research and training program comprising of a series of seminars, presentation, and a research role in knowledge translation for decision-making with Dr Quesnel-Vallée

- Responsible for statistical analyses of a published case-matched clinical study data results of the outcomes of endoscopic controls on bowel leaks and mortality (<https://doi.org/10.5114/wiitm.2019.84851>)

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Roles:

- Women's co-captain for a rowing team at St. Catherine's College, University of Oxford
- Active member of the Manchester Alumni Mentoring Scheme which helps increase access to quality postgraduate education to everyone
- Former president of the University of Manchester Czechoslovak Society
- Former editor at a Manchester Undergraduate Politics Journal '*Juncture*'

Extracurricular Learning:

- Complementary weekly courses in Epidemiology and Tropical Medicine at the Nuffield Department of Population Health, University of Oxford (concurrent to my MSc degree)
- Weekly evening Intermediate French lessons, University of Oxford
- Statistical and coding courses, Department of IT, University of Oxford
- Weekly French lessons, University of Manchester

Volunteering:

- Son Rise Program; Cambridge, UK. From October 2013 to April 2014, I was trained and worked with a family of two autistic children using Son Rise Programme methods to improve their cognitive development, learn pointing and expressing basic needs
- Land of Harmony Foundation; Zilina, SK. During my summers from 2011 to 2015, I helped organize and prepare annual international festivals aimed at integrating stigmatized people with physical disabilities into the wider community. I also led weekly cooking workshops aimed at enabling people with disabilities to gain self-sufficiency and lead functional lives with minimal help needed.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Canadian Population Society (CPS) Conference 2023, York – oral presentation titled '*Marry a doctor, live healthier: a quantitative study of marital health influence under different policy contexts*'
- Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting, April 2023, New Orleans, USA - poster presentation titled '*Understanding unmet medical need in Europe: the role of individual and macrosocial determinants*'
- American Sociological Association (ASA) Annual Meeting, August 2022, Los Angeles, USA – Roundtable presentation titled '*Changes in opioid use, non-prescription drug use and help-seeking behaviours in Canada during the COVID-19 pandemic*'
- Canadian Population Society (CPS) Conference 2022 – oral presentation titled '*Family transitions in Europe: From leaving parental home to first time parenthood*'
- IUHPE 2022, May 2022, Poster Presentation titled: '*Addressing food insecurity: a systematic review of food assistance programs and their effect on poverty and wealth inequality in high income countries*'
- IUHPE 2022, May 2022, Poster Presentation of '*Emerging drug use trends in Canada during the COVID-19 pandemic*'
- EBOH Research Day, March 2020, McGill University, Canada – poster presentation titled: '*Marry a doctor, live healthier: A quantitative study of family health influence in Europe under different macro policy contexts*'
- SALAS June 2017, 2016- Ivanka pri Dunaji, Slovakia- week-long summer conference for Slovak students studying abroad aimed at merging moral philosophy, religion and contemporary social policy issues in context of Slovak Republic and its politics
- SKonferencia June 2014, Kings College London, United Kingdom - platform for involvement of Slovaks studying abroad in shaping the future of Slovakia

PUBLICATIONS

- Bunakova, M. (2019). '*Marry a doctor, live healthier*' - A quantitative study of family health influence in Europe under different macro policy contexts. [Thesis]. Oxford

University Research Archive <https://ora.ox.ac.uk/objects/uuid:4eae0276-03c8-40de-beaa-c195779ecba5>

- Skrovina, M., Bencurik, V., Martinek, L., Machackova, M., Bartos, J., Andel, P., Stepanova, E., **Bunakova, M.**, Vomackova, K. (2019). *The significance of intra-operative fluorescence angiography in miniinvasive low rectal resections*. Videosurgery and Other Miniinvasive Techniques, <https://doi.org/10.5114/wiitm.2019.84851>

COMPETITIONS AND AWARDS

- Anthony H. Hampson Award, 2025, McGill University
- Wolfe Graduate Fellowship, 2025, McGill University
- Emerging Scholar Grant, 2024, Quebec Inter-University Centre for Social Statistics (QUICSS)
- Best Student Paper Award, 2023, Canadian Population Society
- Congress Graduate Merit Award, 2023, Federation for the Humanities and Social Sciences
- Graduate Excellence Award, Fall 2022, McGill University
- Réseau de recherche en santé des populations du Québec (RRSPQ) International Conference Award, 2022, RRSPQ
- Fonds de Recherche du Québec - Société et Culture (FRQSC) Doctoral Research Grant, 2022, FRQSC (<https://doi.org/10.69777/316314>)
- GREAT Award Summer 2022 & Spring 2022, McGill University
- Oswald Hall Prize, 2021, McGill University
- IHSP Internship Award, 2019, McGill University
- Henry Morris Travel Award 2015, University of Cambridge
- Contribution to German 2014- Learning Award, Impington Village College
- 3rd Place, Aliante 2013, World Finals, Sweden

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- Drug and Alcohol Dependence Journal, Elsevier (Reviewer), 2023
- Canadian Population Society Committee (Student Representative), 2023-2025
- Population Association of America Annual Meeting (Discussant), 2023

MEMBERSHIPS AND AFFILIATIONS

- Population Association of America (PAA)
- American Sociological Association (ASA)
- Canadian Population Society (CPS)
- Consortium on Analytics for Data-Driven Decision Making (CAnD3)
- Centre on Population Dynamics, McGill University (CPD)
- McGill Graduate Sociology Students' Association (MGSSA)
- McGill Course Lecturers and Instructions Union (MCLIU)

LANGUAGES¹

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|----------------|-------------|--------------|
| • English – C2 | Slovak – C2 | French – B2 |
| • Czech – C2 | German – B1 | Russian – B1 |

OTHER PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

- R Software and R Studio (working proficiency)
- STATA (working proficiency)
- SPSS (working proficiency)
- Qualtrics (working proficiency)
- Tableau (working proficiency)
- Microsoft Office (working proficiency)
- Canva (working proficiency)

¹ listed under the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages